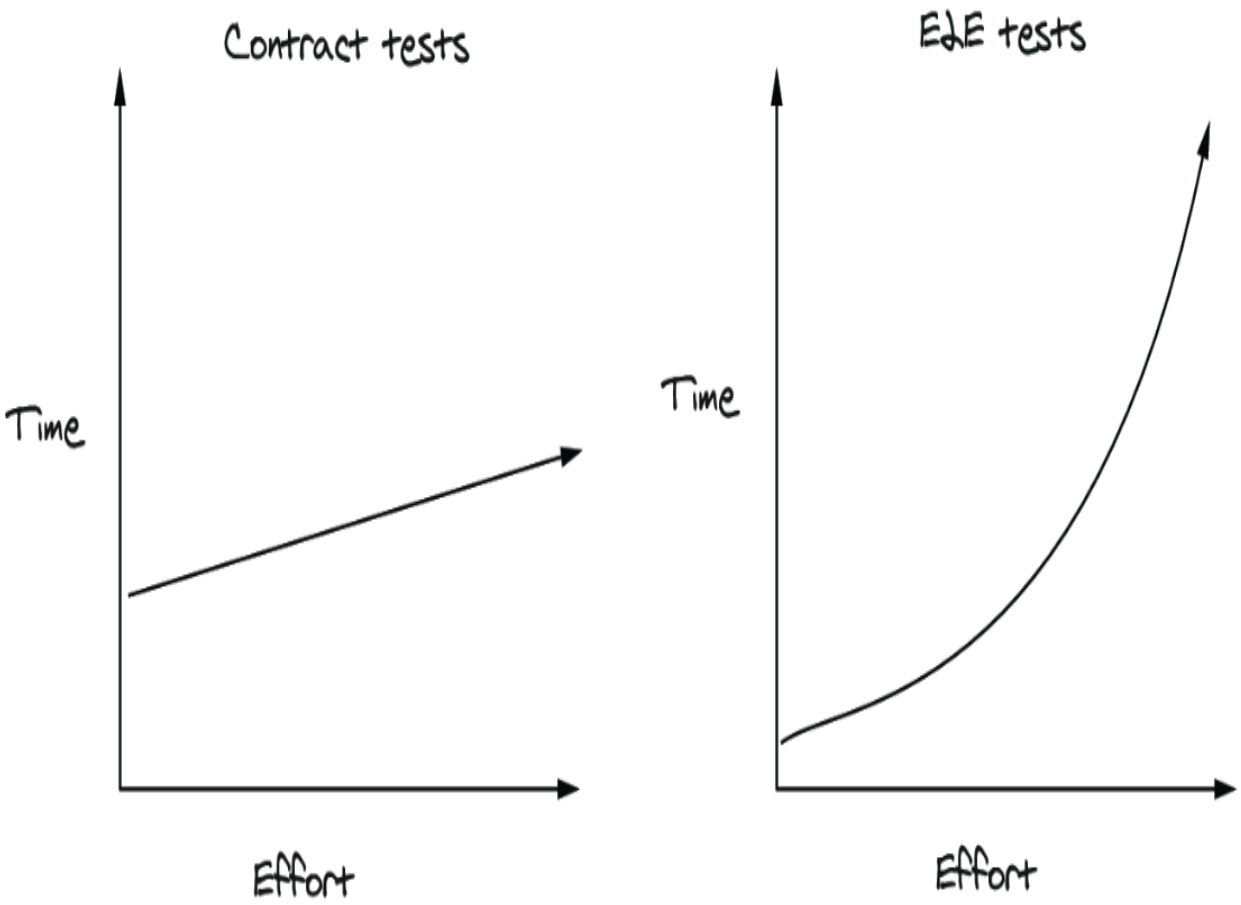


Figure 2.10 The time and effort required for contract tests vs. E2E tests. More time and effort are required for contract tests, but, over time, the effort is minimal compared to E2E tests.

2.5.2 Contract testing requires a mindset shift

Contract testing requires a shift in the team's mindset, encouraging a more collaborative and communicative approach. Contract testing promotes a shared responsibility for ensuring system compatibility, and developers are highly encouraged to write or update any contract tests. If only software testers are writing the contract tests and playing catch-up with the feature that is already implemented, this won't scale over time. Contract testing should be factored in at the same time the code is being developed.

Contract testing also challenges traditional thinking of how a data service or API is to be developed. Because contract testing is closely linked to a test-driven approach, teams need to think first what the consumers need from their API rather than starting the development of what an API can do and telling consumers about it afterward. This promotes teams to think